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# PAPER B



# 2014 ICAS

International Competitions  
and Assessments for Schools

## ENGLISH

Educational Assessment Australia  
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**DO NOT OPEN THIS BOOKLET UNTIL INSTRUCTED.**

**45 QUESTIONS**

**TIME ALLOWED: 45 MINUTES**

**STUDENT'S NAME:**

Read the instructions on the **ANSWER SHEET** and fill in your **NAME, SCHOOL** and **OTHER INFORMATION**.  
Use a 2B or B pencil.  
Do **NOT** use a pen.  
Rub out any mistakes completely.

You **MUST** record your answers on the **ANSWER SHEET**.

Mark only **ONE** answer for each question.  
Your score will be the number of correct answers.  
Marks are **NOT** deducted for incorrect answers.

There are **45 MULTIPLE-CHOICE QUESTIONS** (1–45).  
Use the information provided to choose the **BEST** answer from the four possible options.  
On your **ANSWER SHEET** fill in the oval that matches your answer.

Questions may sometimes be placed next to each other.  
Make sure you read **ACROSS** the page and answer the questions in the correct order.

You are **NOT** allowed to use a dictionary or an electronic translator.

# My little sister is driving me crazy

I was lying in bed, reading, when I heard an odd scratching sound at the door. I sighed. I put my book aside and went to open it. There was my little sister, Bonita, down on the ground on all fours. She looked up at me, opened her mouth and made a long, loud squeaking sound instead of saying my name, James.

I told her to go and bother someone else but she just stared. Then she scuttled past me and hid under my bed. She was amazingly quick! I bent down to see where she was. She was hiding against the wall, in the darkness. I asked her to come out but she shook her head and squeaked again.

Now, you might think this is very strange behaviour, but there is a reason for it. You see, Bonita really wants a guinea pig but Mum says she can't have one. So Bonita says that if she can't have a guinea pig, then she'll pretend to be one until Mum says yes.

So that's what she was doing under my bed. The only way I could get her to come out was by offering her a carrot. I dangled it in the air, and she followed me (crawling, of course) out the door, down the hallway and back to her own room. Phew!

This has been going for three days now. I hope Mum says yes to a guinea pig soon, because my little sister is driving me crazy!



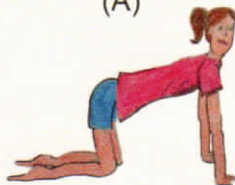
1. Why did James open his door?
- (A) He had to find Bonita.
  - (B) He had finished reading his book.
  - (C) He heard someone squeaking.
  - (D) He heard a scratching sound.
2. Which of these images shows Bonita 'down on the ground on all fours'?



(A)



(B)



(C)



(D)

3. Bonita is acting like a guinea pig because
- (A) she wants her brother to play with her.
  - (B) she wants to persuade her brother to get a guinea pig.
  - (C) she wants to avoid being punished by her mother.
  - (D) she wants her mother to buy her a guinea pig.
4. '(crawling, of course)'
- The words are in brackets because they provide
- (A) a comment.
  - (B) an explanation.
  - (C) an instruction.
  - (D) a suggestion.
5. James said 'Phew!' because
- (A) Bonita had stopped acting like a guinea pig.
  - (B) Bonita had stopped crawling around.
  - (C) Bonita had finally got her way.
  - (D) Bonita had now left his room.
6. After reading the text, which word best describes Bonita?
- (A) stubborn
  - (B) confused
  - (C) angry
  - (D) shy

# Buried treasure

Pirates in stories know where to find buried treasure because **X** always marks the spot! But do people find buried treasure in real life? Do chests full of gold and jewels actually exist? Come on a journey to England. We're going to discover a real treasure hoard!

Imagine that you're a builder in London about 100 years ago. You're in Cheapside, a grim, run-down part of town. Your task is to demolish three old buildings. You're working down in a cellar, breaking through the floor, when suddenly your pickaxe cracks against something hard. You pull the wooden floorboards up and scrape away the dirt, and realise that you're looking at a chest—a very old, wooden chest. You manage to prise open the lid, and are dazzled by a priceless treasure.



Inside the chest are jewelled pendants. There are fine necklaces strung with enamelled flowers. There are necklaces set with amethysts, garnets and emeralds—each golden link made by hand. There are jewelled crosses, a diamond ring, two crystal jugs and a salt cellar with silver and gold decoration, exquisite hat ornaments and a pendant in the shape of a squirrel eating a nut.

And then there are the gems! There are garnets from India, emeralds from Colombia and a white sapphire from Turkey. There is turquoise from Iran and jade from China.

The chest also contains strange and wonderful toadstones. These smooth, brown cup-shaped rocks were believed to ward off poison, and were thought to come from the heads of toads. In reality, they are the fossilised teeth of an ancient fish. The chest contains 14 of these priceless objects.

Did something like this really happen? Yes! In 1912, workmen in Cheapside really did find buried treasure! They found a chest containing the finest collection of 17th-century English jewellery in the world. By looking at paintings of people wearing jewellery, historians could tell that the style of the jewellery in the Cheapside Hoard was worn in England between 1610 and 1630. In those days, Cheapside was famous for its goldsmiths and jewellers. The building where the gems were buried probably housed one of them, and so this chest probably belonged to a jeweller. It was his stock-in-trade: the collection of gems and jewellery that he owned, and that he was working on at the time.

7. What does the word 'hoard' mean, as it is used in the text?
- (A) chest
  - (B) site
  - (C) store
  - (D) box
8. What is a toadstone?
- (A) a poisonous rock
  - (B) an ancient medicine
  - (C) an antique fish
  - (D) a fossilised tooth
9. Which of the following is **NOT** a reason for describing the items in the chest?
- (A) to highlight the unusual items found in the chest
  - (B) to explain why the chest is said to contain some of the finest English jewellery
  - (C) to emphasise the range of jewellery that was made at that time
  - (D) to illustrate how much the Cheapside neighbourhood has changed
10. How did the historians know what time period the jewellery came from?
- (A) They compared the jewellery to what was seen in paintings.
  - (B) They knew how old the wood of the chest was.
  - (C) They matched the age of the building with how deep the chest was buried.
  - (D) They checked the dates that the gems were brought into the country.
11. '...and so this chest probably belonged to a jeweller.'
- In the sentence, the word 'probably' shows that
- (A) historians disagree about who the owner of the chest was.
  - (B) evidence indicates that the chest was likely owned by a jeweller.
  - (C) historians are convinced that the chest was owned by a jeweller.
  - (D) only the workmen who discovered the chest knew who the owner was.
12. In the last paragraph, the information after the colon (:) is closest to being
- (A) a definition.
  - (B) a description.
  - (C) an example.
  - (D) an illustration.
13. The writer captures the reader's interest by
- (A) using exact dates.
  - (B) referring to what the reader already knows.
  - (C) repeating important information.
  - (D) addressing the reader directly.



# Hardly out of this world

The latest *Tyranno* movie, *Tyranno 2: Earth defence*, has just taken a nosedive and crash-landed at a cinema near you—all in 3D! While the original *Tyranno* was a visual feast with strong characters and a gripping story, *Tyranno 2* has failed miserably as so many sequels do. It is loosely based on the second book in the excellent series by Lillian Sidle, but it has mutated into a truly awful movie. In particular, parts of the plot which were significant in the book have been left out of the script. This plot-thinning has had the effect of creating characters that are somewhat one-dimensional—even if they look great in their dinosaur costumes.

Simon Gray, who did such a fabulous job in the first movie, plays Tyro. He is responsible for defending Earth from the evil pirate dinosaur Piratopod. Help with this mission is provided by a couple of velociraptor co-stars named Barry (Evan Green) and Kevin (Brian Scott). Piratopod has invented a solar-powered meteor magnet and intends to capture meteors from their space orbits, re-directing them onto a collision course with Earth. Tyro must mobilise the Earth Defence Team to locate and disable Piratopod's secret weapon. It's a typical 'good-guy-fights-bad-guy-and-overcomes-a-few-problems-along-the-way-while-winning-in-the-end' sort of movie. Usually this is a reasonable formula for success. However, the plot is mind-numbingly predictable, with gaps in the story that become obvious quite early on. This also means that the story tends to jolt strangely from one scene to the next.

I often use a 'spoiler alert' to warn readers when I intend to provide key details about a movie. In this case however, the story is so under-developed that there aren't many key details to reveal. You would think the director might have considered borrowing ideas from Sidle's books to make the characters more interesting—for instance Piratopod's twisted personality was actually explained as the result of traumatic events in his past. But no.

It is clearly in special effects that all the time and energy were invested in this movie, and if you love this sort of thing you will be enthralled. The views of Earth and the Moon are spectacular. I wasn't sitting in a cinema wearing 3D glasses; I was out there in space! Although the story is weak and the characters under-developed, the special effects are brilliant. They are the icing on a stale cake!

If the movie makers had followed Lillian Sidle's work more closely, this movie could have been a success. My suggestion to fans is to save your money on this movie and buy the book instead.



Rated: PG

Reviewed by *Lee Evan*

14. What does the word 'mutated' mean?
- (A) changed
  - (B) shifted
  - (C) progressed
  - (D) decreased
15. Why does the reviewer describe the characters as 'one-dimensional'?
- (A) This is how the characters are portrayed in the book.
  - (B) The actors did not have the experience to play the parts.
  - (C) There is a lack of character development in the movie.
  - (D) The characters are played by unknown actors in the movie.
16. What is a 'spoiler alert'?
- (A) a suggestion to change the plot
  - (B) a hint that a negative comment will be made
  - (C) a warning that key parts of the plot will be exposed
  - (D) a clue that links the movie with the book
17. The word 'enthralled' means
- (A) curious. (B) fascinated. (C) puzzled. (D) amused.
18. Which statement would the reviewer most likely agree with?
- (A) The audience will disregard the changes to the storyline.
  - (B) The changes in the plot weakened the special effects.
  - (C) The cast was more inexperienced than expected.
  - (D) The movie was more show than substance.
19. What is the main technique used by the reviewer to persuade readers not to watch the movie?
- (A) describing what it is like to view the movie in 3D
  - (B) exaggerating the strengths of the book
  - (C) contrasting the movie with the book
  - (D) including humour
20. The overall tone of the review is
- (A) angry.
  - (B) rude.
  - (C) dissatisfied.
  - (D) arrogant.

## *Make a wish*

Carl sat chewing, his glasses balanced on the very tip of his nose. He was concentrating very hard. Cass watched fascinated. One more chew and they would slip off. 'Well,' Carl lifted his head and his glasses slid back into place, 'I don't know if we can do anything more, Cass. If adults can't stop them, what can we do?'

The twins ate in silence, watching the sun slip behind the distant skyline, silhouetting the tall faceless office blocks that poked out of a shifting yellow haze. The din of the city traffic barely reached them. It mingled with the warm shushing sound of the surrounding park.

The Trumper Tree rose above them, majestic and tall, its twisted branches and gnarled trunk swirling in strange patterns. It looked as if it reached into the sky forever.

'I'm going to save a leaf from the Trumper Tree as a memento,' said Cass and she picked up a fallen leaf. 'Here's one for you,' and she handed it to Carl. He was very quiet. The air became heavy and still. The park seemed to be holding its breath. 'Let's make a wish, a wish to make things right,' whispered Cass.

'I don't believe in wishes,' was Carl's reply, but he didn't push the leaf away; he placed it carefully in his pocket.

Around them the valley waited, motionless and silent. Cass shivered. 'I feel strange, eerie. I can almost hear the tree speaking to me.'

'What am I supposed to listen for?'

'Quiet! Can't you hear? There's a sound in the leaves, a sort of stirring, a movement, a rustling.'

'And for your next trick there'll be gnomes in the grass.' Carl was not impressed.

Cass was listening intently. 'It's saying that now is the time, now is special, if we wish now something important will happen.'

'And pigs might fly. Come on Cass, it's time we went home.'

'Please let's try one wish now. Come on Carl, please ...!'

'Oh, all right. Just one, then we must go or Mum and Dad will be late for that meeting.'

'Let's put our arms around the tree and wish hard for something to save it.'

21. What was Carl doing in the first paragraph?
- (A) arguing with his sister
  - (B) hiding from his parents
  - (C) quickly finishing a big meal
  - (D) thinking deeply about a problem
22. The story is set in
- (A) a park.
  - (B) a building.
  - (C) a city street.
  - (D) a sports field.
23. In the second paragraph, the words 'silhouetting the tall faceless office blocks' refer to the effect of the
- (A) sun.                      (B) tree.                      (C) haze.                      (D) skyline.
24. Personification is a type of description that gives human qualities to something which is not human.
- Which quotation uses personification?
- (A) 'The twins ate in silence'
  - (B) 'The park seemed to be holding its breath.'
  - (C) 'There's a sound in the leaves'
  - (D) 'And pigs might fly.'
25. In the third paragraph, why does the writer describe the Trumper Tree as having a 'gnarled trunk swirling in strange patterns'?
- (A) to emphasise how bright the sun is
  - (B) to create a mysterious atmosphere
  - (C) to make a comparison with city buildings
  - (D) to highlight the colour of its leaves and branches
26. Cass gave a leaf to Carl because
- (A) she planned to show him a trick.
  - (B) she wanted him to keep it as a souvenir.
  - (C) she was sharing her love of nature with him.
  - (D) she knew that his hobby was collecting small things.
27. Which quotation shows that Carl would follow Cass and make a wish?
- (A) 'He was very quiet.'
  - (B) 'What am I supposed to listen for?'
  - (C) 'Come on Cass, it's time we went home.'
  - (D) 'Just one, then we must go'
28. Which word best describes Cass?
- (A) logical
  - (B) efficient
  - (C) reckless
  - (D) persistent

# Creepy underwater crawlies

Going underwater is about to get creepier. Lurking in the shallow waters of your favourite beach and inhabiting the depths of the coldest oceans are creeping, crawling sea spiders. Ranging in size from one millimetre to more than 90 centimetres, these creatures look like the stars of a science fiction horror movie.



*A sea spider in the McMurdo Sound in Antarctica*

With their small bodies and really long legs, it is easy to have nightmares about sea spiders larger than your head crawling all over you, but it gets creepier. Sea spiders are equipped with a proboscis (a long appendage on their head) for feeding on their prey. These carnivorous crawlies insert their proboscis into the soft body of an invertebrate and then suck out the juicy goodness. Surprisingly, the poor prey often survives this gruesome attack. Although this type of feeding sounds gross, invertebrates such as sea sponges and sea anemones are generally larger than the spider, and so will survive being fed on ... most of the time.

There are more than 1300 known species of sea spiders. They can have four, five or six pairs of legs. Their bodies are so thin that they do not need a respiratory system; instead, their body surface is large enough to allow them to breathe by diffusion, which means oxygen is absorbed through their skin. In fact, their bodies are so small that their organs spread out to their legs. Many sea spiders that live deep in the ocean are blind.

Sea spiders are such unusual creatures that scientists are still a little puzzled about how to classify them. Sea spiders are not considered true spiders or arachnids. They have a segmented exoskeleton, which makes them arthropods just like insects, crabs and spiders. But other strange features such as their proboscis make it difficult to decide exactly what type of arthropod they are.

Marine zoologist Dr Claudia Arango of the Australian Museum finds sea spiders fascinating, especially the ones that live in Antarctica. 'They are more diverse, more abundant, bigger and weirder than sea spiders in other parts of the world: that makes them a very attractive fauna,' says Dr Arango.

Next time you go to the beach, head over to the rocks and investigate; you may just find a little sea spider camouflaged in the shallow water. But don't worry, the really big ones only live in the depths of the Antarctic Ocean.

29. Sea spiders feed on sea anemones because
- (A) they have soft bodies.
  - (B) they have thin bodies.
  - (C) they are larger than their predators.
  - (D) they are able to survive after being attacked.
30. What is the meaning of the word 'gruesome'?
- (A) frequent
  - (B) horrifying
  - (C) unexpected
  - (D) sudden
31. Sea spiders breathe by diffusion. This allows them to
- (A) store oxygen in their legs.
  - (B) take in oxygen through their skin.
  - (C) control their respiratory system.
  - (D) suck oxygen from their prey.
32. 'Many sea spiders that live deep in the ocean are blind.'
- Which word or words could be placed at the beginning of this sentence in the third paragraph?
- (A) As a result
  - (B) However
  - (C) Yet
  - (D) In addition
33. Why are sea spiders described in the text as 'unusual creatures'?
- (A) They are arachnids and they breathe by diffusion.
  - (B) They are invertebrates and they are also carnivores.
  - (C) They are arthropods and they have a proboscis.
  - (D) They can live in both deep and shallow water.
34. What is the main purpose of the final paragraph?
- (A) to scare readers into staying away from sea spiders
  - (B) to urge readers to investigate the sea spiders of the Antarctic Ocean
  - (C) to reassure readers that sea spiders are unlikely to be a threat to them
  - (D) to warn readers against taking unnecessary risks with sea spiders
35. What is the text underneath the photograph called?
- (A) caption
  - (B) label
  - (C) subheading
  - (D) glossary
36. What does the writer assume about her readers?
- (A) They are scared of spiders.
  - (B) They know what a sea spider looks like.
  - (C) They understand what a proboscis is.
  - (D) They have studied the Antarctic Ocean.

# Messing about in boats

'Do you know, I've never been in a boat before in all my life.'

'What?' cried the Rat, open-mouthed: 'Never been in a—you never—well I—what have you been doing, then?'

'Is it so nice as all that?' asked the Mole shyly, though he was quite prepared to believe it as he leant back in his seat and surveyed the cushions, the oars and all the fascinating fittings, and he felt the boat sway lightly under him.

'Nice? It's the only thing', said the Water Rat solemnly, as he leant forward for his stroke. 'Believe me, my young friend, there is nothing—absolutely nothing—half so much worth doing as simply messing about in boats. Simply messing', he went on dreamily: 'messing—about—in—boats; messing—'

'Look ahead, Rat!' cried the Mole suddenly.

It was too late; the boat struck the bank full tilt. The dreamer, the joyous oarsman, lay on his back at the bottom of the boat, his heels in the air.

'—about in boats—or with boats', the Rat went on composedly, picking himself up with a pleasant laugh. 'In or out of 'em, it doesn't matter. Nothing seems really to matter, that's the charm of it. Whether you get away, or whether you don't; whether you arrive at your destination or whether you reach somewhere else, or whether you never get anywhere at all, you're always busy, and you never do anything in particular; and when you've done it there's always something else to do and you can do it if you like, but you'd much better not. Look here! If you've really nothing else on hand this morning, supposing we drop down the river together, and have a long day of it?'

The Mole waggled his toes from sheer happiness, spread his chest with a sigh of full contentment, and leaned back blissfully into the soft cushions. 'What a day I'm having!' he said. 'Let us start at once!' 'Hold hard a minute, then!' said the Rat. He looped the painter through a ring in his landing-stage, climbed up into his hole above, and after a short interval reappeared staggering under a fat, wicker luncheon-basket.

'Shove that under your feet', he observed to the Mole, as he passed it down into the boat. Then he untied the painter and took the sculls again.

'What's inside it?' asked the Mole, wriggling with curiosity.

'There's cold chicken inside it', replied the Rat briefly; 'coldhamcoldbeefpickledgherkins saladfrenchrollscresssandwichespottedmeatgingerbeerlemonadesodawater —'

'O stop, stop', cried the Mole in ecstasies: 'This is too much!'



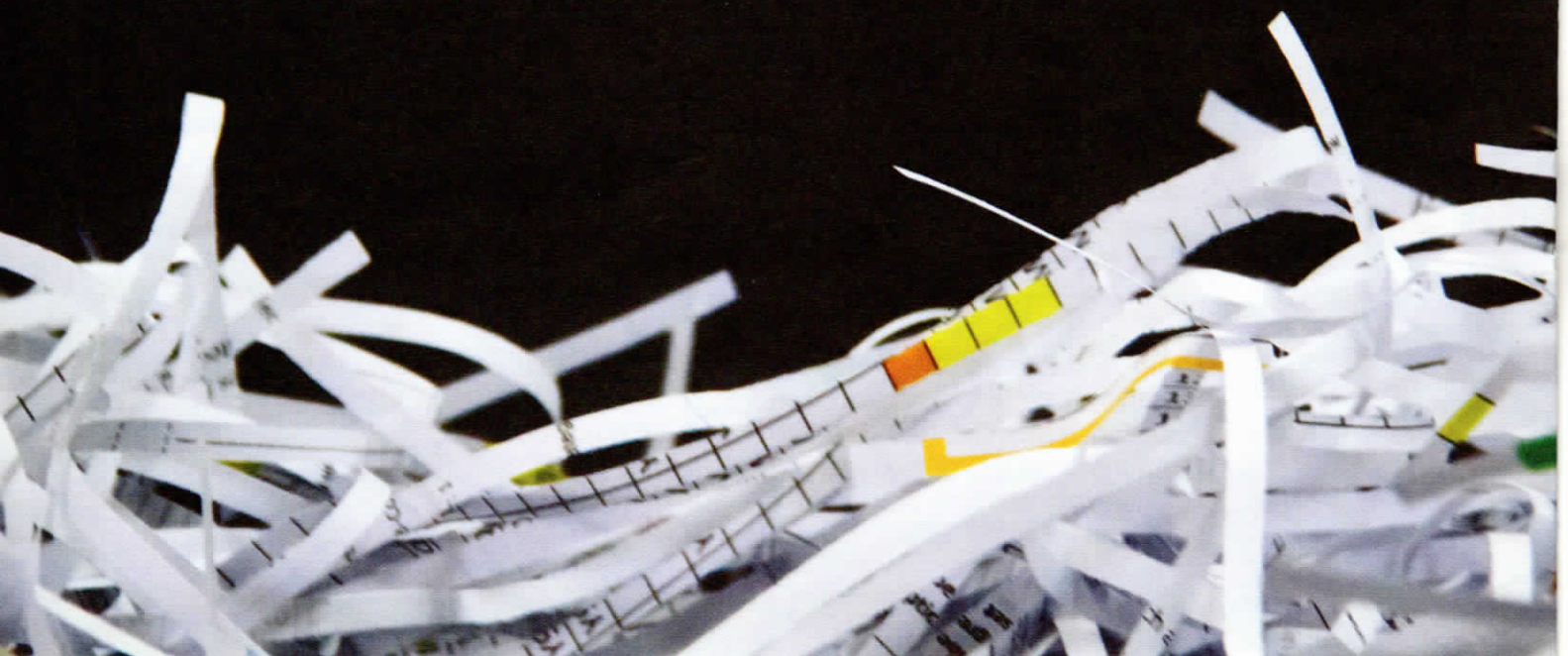
37. The author uses the word 'open-mouthed' to indicate that the Rat is
- (A) sleeping.
  - (B) disbelieving.
  - (C) extremely happy.
  - (D) about to speak.
38. The word 'surveyed', as it is used in the text, means
- (A) felt.
  - (B) tested.
  - (C) looked over.
  - (D) took hold of.
39. Which of the following from the text does **NOT** refer to the Rat?
- (A) 'young friend'
  - (B) 'dreamer'
  - (C) 'joyous oarsman'
  - (D) 'pleasant laugh'
40. 'Nothing seems really to matter, that's the charm of it.'
- The word 'it' refers to
- (A) lying on the bottom of the boat.
  - (B) embarking on a journey.
  - (C) pottering about in a boat.
  - (D) having unplanned adventures.
41. The removal of spaces and commas in the list of picnic food
- (A) adds emphasis to the quality of the Rat's food.
  - (B) stresses that the Rat is distracted by the food.
  - (C) shows how excited the Rat is about the food.
  - (D) highlights how much food the Rat can eat.
42. Which of the following quotations most shows the Mole's inexperience?
- (A) 'asked the Mole shyly'
  - (B) 'cried the Mole suddenly'
  - (C) 'leaned back blissfully'
  - (D) 'cried the Mole in ecstasies'
43. Which of the following is the Rat most likely to say?
- (A) 'Boating is a means of getting where you want to go.'
  - (B) 'Boating is as much about skill as it is about enjoyment.'
  - (C) 'Boating is about having nothing to do and all day to do it in.'
  - (D) 'Boating wastes time unless the experience is used wisely.'

For questions 44 and 45 choose the correct option to complete the passage.

# Recycling

Recycling is a word we hear a lot these days. It is a way of turning rubbish back into usable materials. One common example of recycling is \_\_\_\_ (44) \_\_\_\_ paper waste (such as cardboard) and break it down using a combination of water and chemicals. Once it's been broken down, it can be cleaned and processed into new sheets of paper, with no need to cut down any more trees! Recycled paper is certainly better for the environment \_\_\_\_ (45) \_\_\_\_ it costs more to produce.

44. (A) having taken  
(B) taking  
(C) to take  
(D) took
45. (A) for  
(B) even if  
(C) since  
(D) as long as



**END OF  
PAPER**

ICAS PAPER B ENG 2014 – ANSWER KEY

| Question Number | Paper B |
|-----------------|---------|
| 1               | D       |
| 2               | C       |
| 3               | D       |
| 4               | A       |
| 5               | D       |
| 6               | A       |
| 7               | C       |
| 8               | D       |
| 9               | D       |
| 10              | A       |
| 11              | B       |
| 12              | A       |
| 13              | D       |
| 14              | A       |
| 15              | C       |
| 16              | C       |
| 17              | B       |
| 18              | D       |
| 19              | C       |
| 20              | C       |
| 21              | D       |
| 22              | A       |
| 23              | A       |
| 24              | B       |
| 25              | B       |
| 26              | B       |
| 27              | D       |
| 28              | D       |
| 29              | A       |
| 30              | B       |

| Question Number | Paper B |
|-----------------|---------|
| 31              | B       |
| 32              | D       |
| 33              | C       |
| 34              | C       |
| 35              | A       |
| 36              | A       |
| 37              | B       |
| 38              | C       |
| 39              | A       |
| 40              | C       |
| 41              | C       |
| 42              | A       |
| 43              | C       |
| 44              | C       |
| 45              | B       |